



Hey Dad, how can I create a painting on the laptop by putting many images together like I did with my collage in art class?

It is very easy. Come let me show you.



Layers are used in digital image editing to separate different elements of an image. They can be used to add depth to a piece of art. Multiple elements can be added to a single image with layers.

As we can see from the given image, layering is similar to creating a collage. One image is placed on top of the other. By adding more layers to your image, we can create more depth in an image. We can also modify each layer individually.



Layered collage
Courtesy: firstpalette.com

This layering technique is often used to combine multiple images to create a single structure or image. In this activity, we will layer multiple images to create a mountain scenery.

Activity 1

Use multiple images to create a layered landscape image.



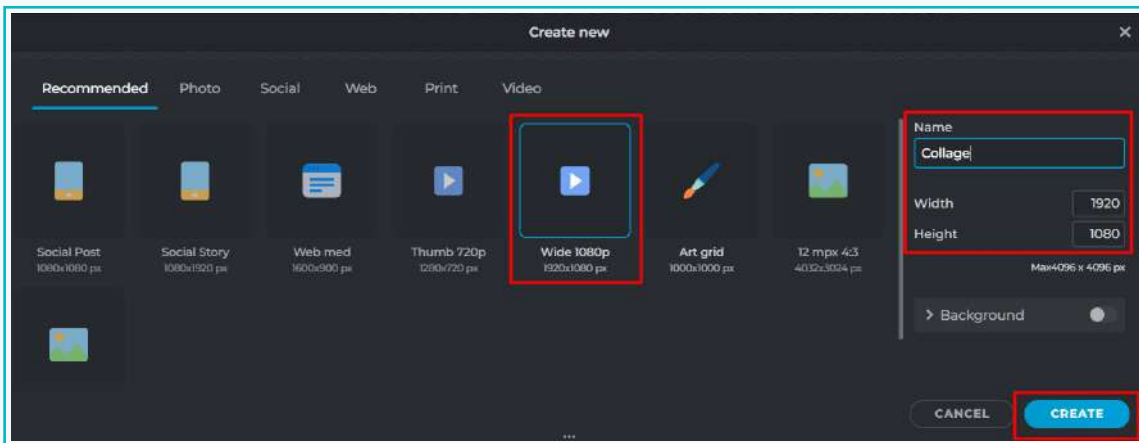
Activity 1

Ideate the scene in the form of different layers. Think of what each image can represent.

For example: the green layer can be the grass, etc.

1 Create a new image called 'collage'. Its size should be 'Full HD'.

a. Go to Create New > Wide 1080p > set name > click on Create.



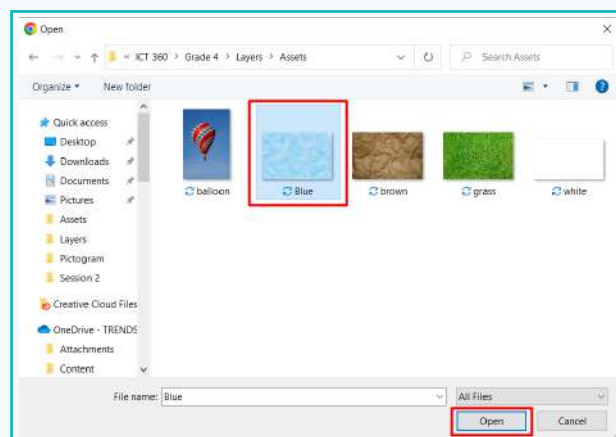
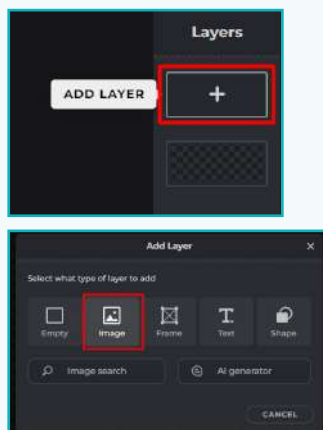
b. This will create a blank canvas with the size 1920X1080 pixels.

2 Click on Add image to import an image to the canvas.

a. First, we will import the image for the bottom layer. In this case, the sky is the bottom layer.

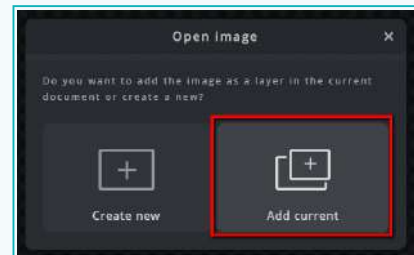
b. Select the blue water colour image.

c. Go to Layers> Add Layer > Add image > Browse > select the image and click 'Open'.



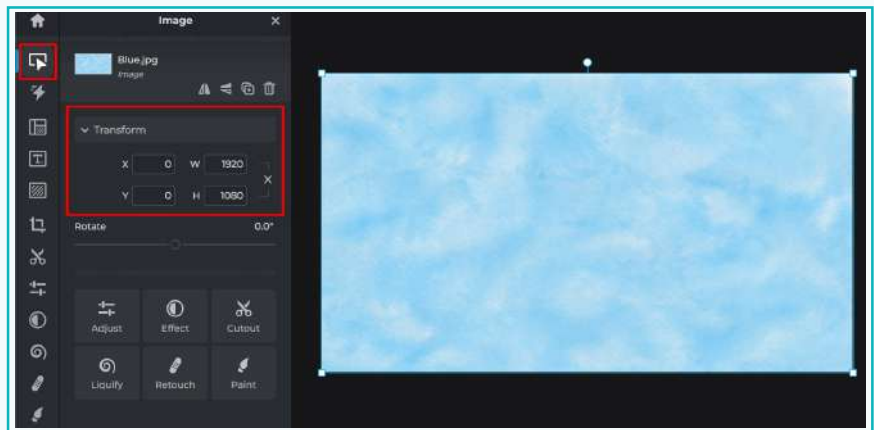
Activity 1

- d. To add the image to the current canvas, click 'Add current'.



- 3 Select the Arrange tool. Drag the corner handles to resize the image. It should fit into the dimensions of the canvas .

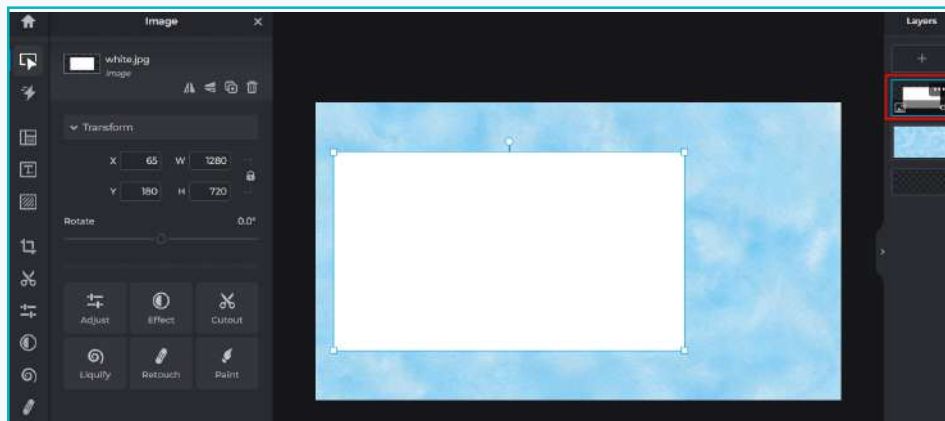
- a. The Arrange tool allows us to resize and position the image.



Note:

Use the Lock aspect toggle switch to lock the image scaling. It can be set to proportional or free scaling.

- 4 Now, we'll add the next image to our canvas. With the same steps as before, add the image called 'white'. We will use this to create snow mountains.

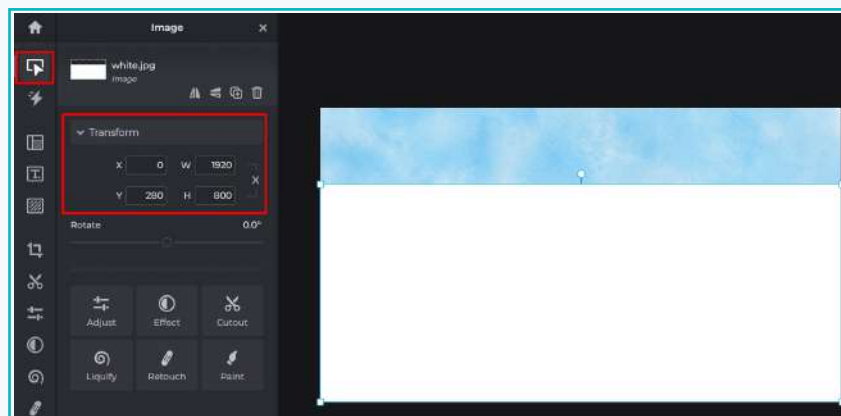


Activity 1

- a. Observe how the white image is added automatically added on top of the blue image. It is also visible in the layers panel.



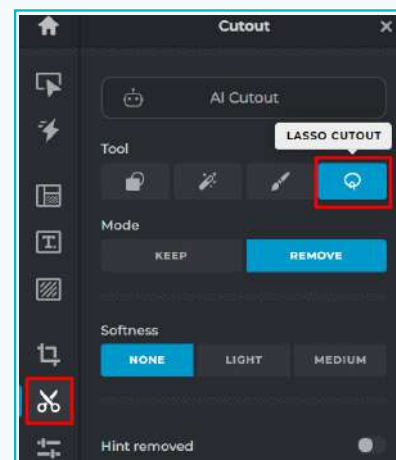
- 5 Use the Arrange tool to adjust the size of the white image.



- 6 Right now, it is just a white rectangle on the blue background. To make it look like snow-clad mountains, we need to cut the shape and delete the part that we don't need.

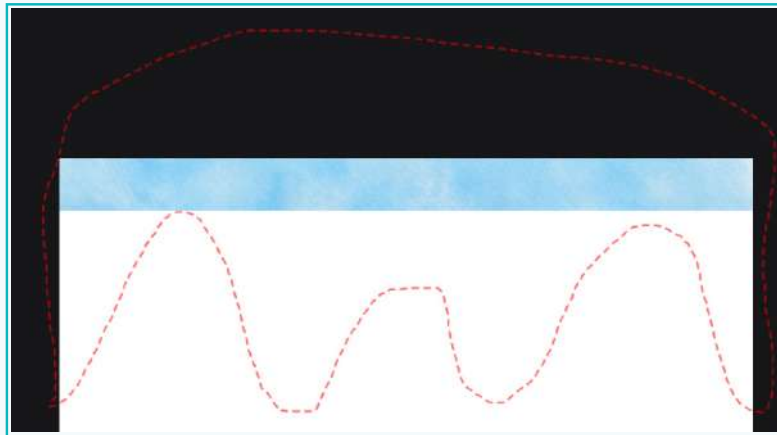
The **Cutout** tool is used to extract or delete a particular part of an image. Cut outs can be of any shape, a particular colour, or of a manually selected shape. We use the editor to select a shape.

- 7 Select the Cutout tool. It has various options. For the mountains, we will use the Lasso cutout option.

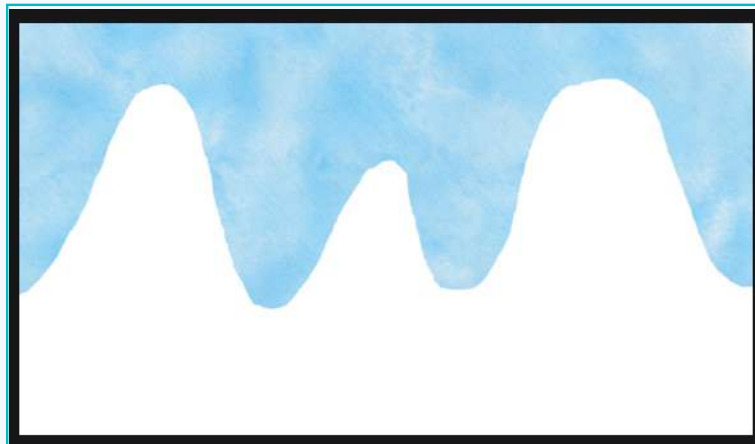


Activity 1

- 8 The Lasso cutout tool lets us draw and select the area to be removed or kept.
- 9 Set the 'mode' to 'remove'. Draw shapes of mountains on the white layer which will be cut out.



- 10 Release the left mouse key to view the result:



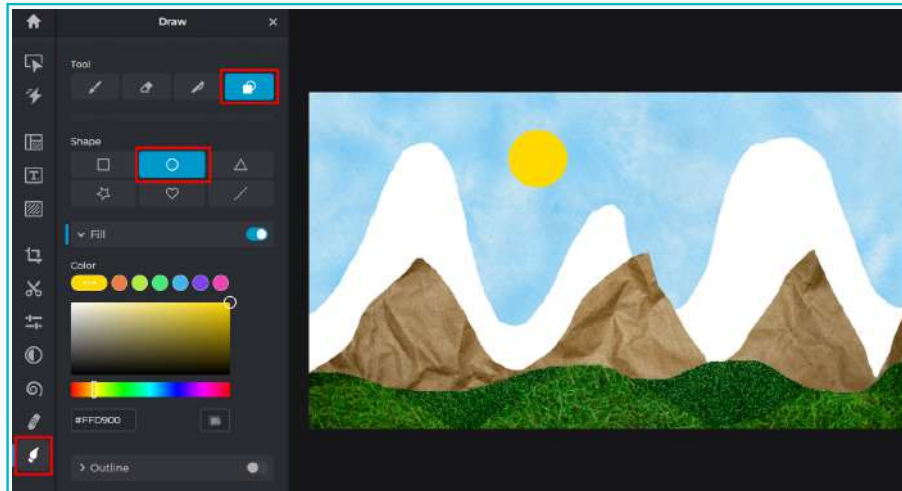
- 11 Similarly, add more images and use the Cutout tool to delete unnecessary parts of the image. They should look like the elements of the scene you want to create.

Note:

Remember to create the bottom most layer first and the top most layer last.

Activity 1

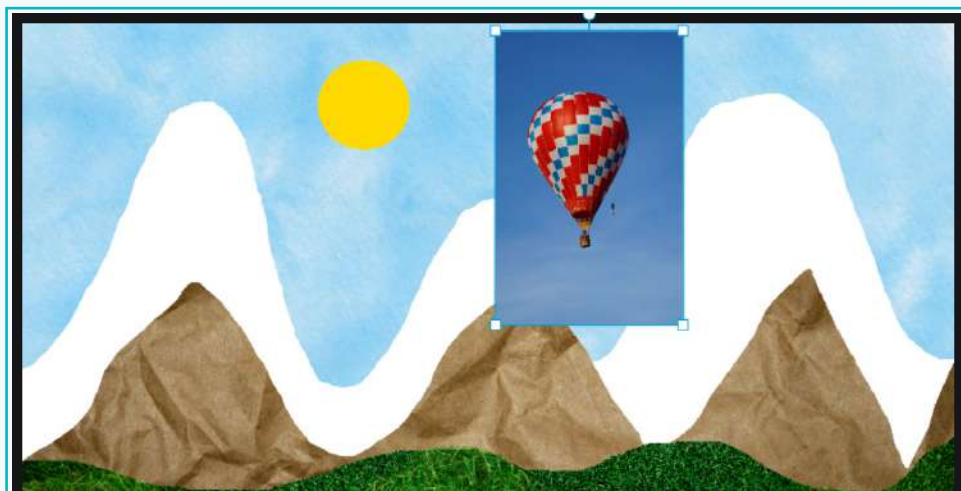
- 12 Create layers for hills, the grass, and the sun as shown in the image.



Activity 2

- To add an interesting element to the scene, let's add:

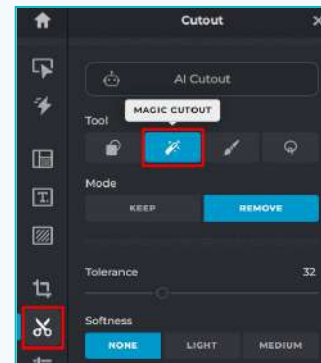
- 1 Follow the earlier steps to add the image of a hot air balloon to the canvas.



Activity 2

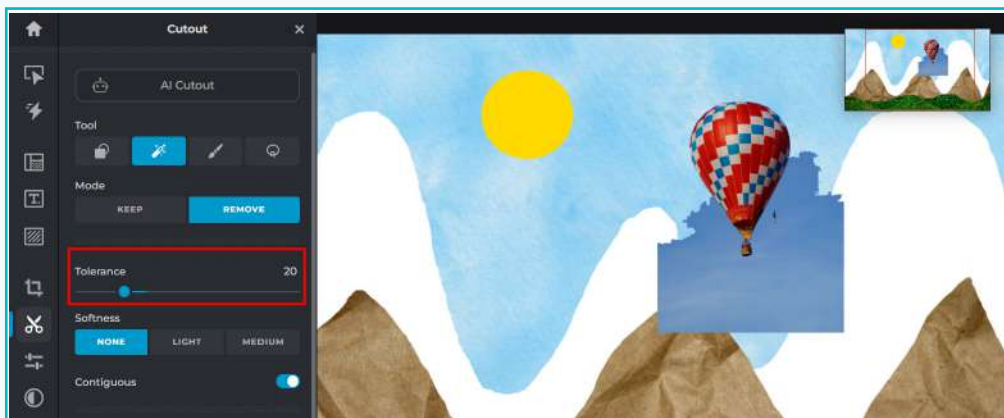
2 We will use the **magic cutout tool** to remove the sky in the hot air balloon image.

3 Select the Cutout tool and set it to magic cutout.

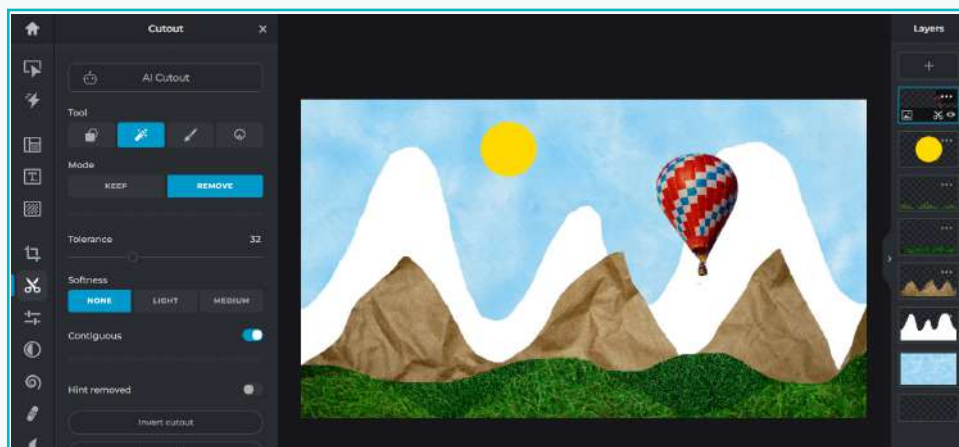


4 The sky contains only shades of blue. There aren't any other elements to distract from it.

5 Set the Tolerance value to around 20 and click on regions of the sky that are visible.



6 Try different tolerance values to remove the sky from the hot air balloon image.

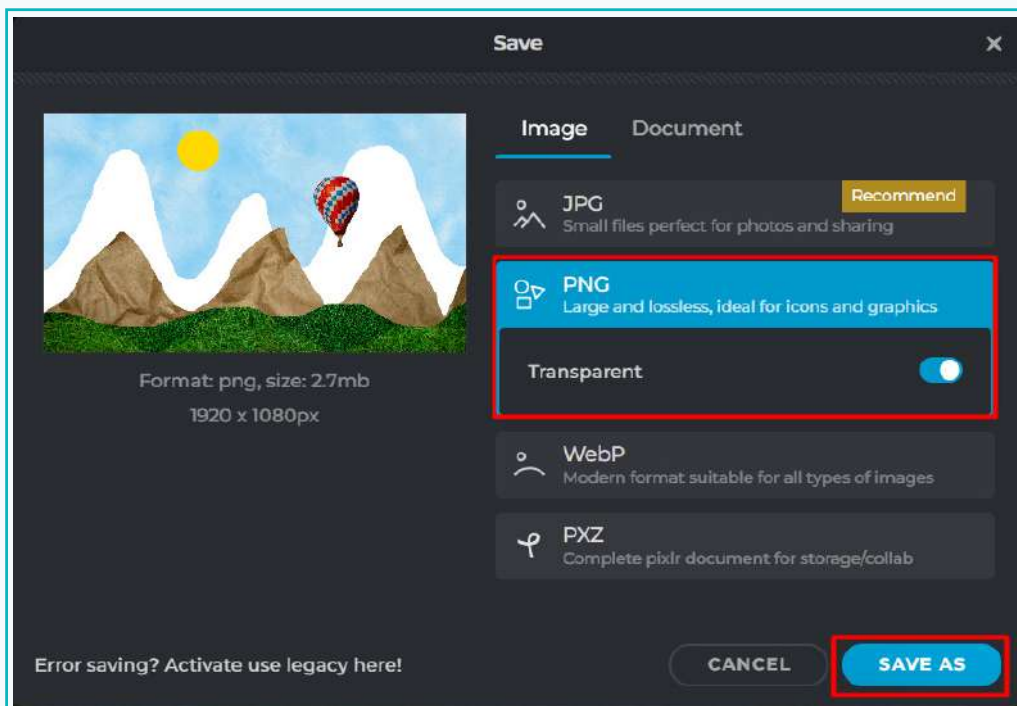


Activity 2

- 7 Use the Arrange tool to move the balloon and position it in the sky.



- 8 Now that our image is complete, save the final image as a PNG. The quality of the image is not compromised in the PNG format.



Activity

 Final output:



In this lesson, we learnt how to use layers and create beautiful images. Layers help us add multiple elements and depth to an image. They also allow us to individually work on each element making it easy to edit our images.

Exercise

 Fill in the blanks

- 1 _____ are used in digital image editing to separate different elements of an image.
- 2 _____ tool is used to extract/delete a particular section in the image. _____ tool lets us manually select the area to be removed/kept.
- 3 _____ cutout tool lets us keep or remove a colour range which matches the set tolerance value from the image.

Exercise

Match the Following

4

a.



b.



c.



d.



e.



f.



g.



h. Adjust Tool

i. Crop Tool

j. Retouch Tool

k. Effect Tool

l. Arrange Tool

m. Cutout Tool

n. Add Image



Tech Flash

- **Layers** : Layers are used in digital image editing to separate different elements of an image.
- **Arrange tool** : This lets us resize and position the image.
- **Cutout tool** : This is used to extract/delete a particular section in the image.